

Ivan Yuri “Lion” P. De Leon

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EDUCATION

Ateneo de Manila University

Master in Data Science

Quezon City, Philippines

May 2026

- Graduate Assistant – Mathematics Department & Environmental Science Department
- *Coursework*: Deep Learning, Computer Vision, Bayesian Techniques, Time Series Forecasting, Big Data Systems

Ateneo de Manila University

BS in Applied Mathematics (Data Science), Minor in Economics

Quezon City, Philippines

May 2025

- **Summa Cum Laude**; Mulry Award for Literary Excellence; University Academic Scholar (Full Tuition Scholarship)
- **Managing Editor & Finance Officer**, HEIGHTS Ateneo (official literary & artistic publication)
- *Coursework*: Graph Theory, Operations Research, Business Intelligence, Financial Economics, Seminar on Finance, Linguistics

EXPERIENCE

TARA Program

AI Alignment Participant

Quezon City, Philippines

Mar 2026 - Jun 2026

- Completed an APAC-focused AI alignment program with peers from Singapore, Japan, and Australia, covering transformer architectures, mechanistic interpretability, reinforcement learning, model evaluation, and LLM agents.
- Developed two capstone projects: (1) [mechanistic interpretability](#) of single-agent drift in multi-agent systems, in collaboration with researchers from Sydney (among top 9 of 60 capstone projects); (2) [jailbreaking LLMs](#) using persuasive Filipino prompts.

Nara Institute of Science and Technology

Human-AI Interaction Lab Intern

Nara, Japan

Jan 2026

- Developed a [multimodal benchmark](#) for Vision-Language Models to evaluate cultural heritage recognition and understanding, implementing API-based model evaluation and an LLM-judge pipeline for automated scoring. On track for O-COCOSDA 2026.

Ayala Corporation

Data Analytics and AI Intern

Makati, Philippines

Apr 2025 - Sept 2025

- Led a cross-functional initiative with Ayala Corp and AC Mobility teams, developing predictive models to identify key car sales drivers, informing a promo-effectiveness metric and improving sales forecasting.
- Conducted attrition and leave analysis for 200+ employees and automated workforce analytics reporting by developing a real-time HR dashboard, reducing report generation time from monthly to instant.
- Modeled user behavior for 5,000+ early adopters in a mobility app using Markov chains, which guided feature prioritization.
- Supported data engineering processes, including large-scale querying, preprocessing, and quality control.

Bank of the Philippine Islands

Data Science Intern

Makati, Philippines

Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

- Delivered 4 finance-focused data projects, covering market data scraping, product recommendation systems, customer segmentation for tailored service delivery, and explainable AI for credit risk modeling.
- **Finalist (3/20 teams)** in a case competition across multiple companies under the Ayala conglomerate, collaborating with five senior leaders to design an innovation-driven solution impacting 10,000+ employees.

PROJECTS

[\[Portfolio Website\]](#)

Graph-Based Analysis of Customer-Merchant Payment Networks

Master's Capstone

- Independently designed a novel customer-merchant affinity metric and applied it via community detection and graph neural networks, uncovering behavioral patterns of high-value customers and identifying untapped candidates with high-value potential.

BEA: Blue Eagle Assistant

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#) [\[Video\]](#)

- Built a multi-agent university chatbot using LangGraph and Streamlit, enabling students to query handbook references, university policies, and contacts through a RAG-powered pipeline.

Volatility Modeling on the USD-PHP Exchange Rate using ARMA-GARCH Models

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Paper\]](#)

- Modeled daily USD-PHP exchange rates using a joint ARIMA-GARCH approach, capturing mean dynamics and time-varying volatility to forecast near-term currency movements, producing insights applicable to policy and financial risk management.

We Are Convinced That Persuasion is Linear and Bilingual in LLMs

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Paper\]](#)

- Built a mechanistic interpretability and evaluation pipeline for LLM persuasion, identifying a linear persuasion direction in LLMs and validating it causally via activation steering across English and Tagalog, contributing to research on persuasion risk.

PUBLICATIONS

PACUTE: Phonology-, Affix-, and Character-level Understanding of Tokens for Filipino

[\[Preprint\]](#)

- Developed a diagnostic benchmark of 4,600 tasks for morphological understanding in Filipino, covering infixation, reduplication, and diacritic-driven distinctions that standard tokenizers fail to capture. Submitted to EMNLP 2026.

OTHER DETAILS

- **Tools**: Python (Scikit-learn, PyTorch), R, SQL, Power BI, Apache Spark, Google Cloud Platform, Java, Git, Django, Streamlit
- **Data Skills**: NLP, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Network Analysis, Time Series, Big Data Processing, Web Scraping
- **Advocacy**: AI Safety (Participant on [TARA](#), [BlueDot Impact](#), & [AISD](#)); Filipino Intellectualization (Research on Filipino LLMs)